

How to Get Rich

(without getting lucky):

Seek wealth, not money or status. Wealth is having assets that earn while you sleep. Money is how we transfer time and wealth. Status is your place in the social hierarchy.

Ignore people playing status games. They gain status by attacking people playing wealth creation games.

You will get rich by giving society what it wants but does not yet know how to get. At scale.

The Internet has massively broadened the possible space of careers. Most people haven't figured this out yet.

Pick business partners with high intelligence, energy, and, above all, integrity.

Learn to sell. Learn to build. If you can do both, you will be unstoppable.

Specific knowledge is knowledge that you cannot be trained for. If society can train you, it can train someone else, and replace you.

Building specific knowledge will feel like play to you but will look like work to others.

Specific knowledge is often highly technical or creative. It cannot be outsourced or automated.

The most accountable people have singular, public, and risky brands: Oprah, Trump, Kanye, Elon.

Fortunes require leverage. Business leverage comes from capital, people, and products with no marginal cost of replication (code and media).

Labor means people working for you. It's the oldest and most fought-over form of leverage. Labor leverage will impress your parents, but don't waste your life chasing it.

Code and media are permissionless leverage. They're the leverage behind the newly rich. You can create software and media that works for you while you sleep.

If you can't code, write books and blogs, record videos and podcasts.

Judgement requires experience, but can be built faster by learning foundational skills.

Understand that ethical wealth creation is possible. If you secretly despise wealth, it will elude you.

You're not going to get rich renting out your time. You must own equity - a piece of a business - to gain your financial freedom.

Pick an industry where you can play long term games with long term people.

Play iterated games. All the returns in life, whether in wealth, relationships, or knowledge, come from compound interest.

Don't partner with cynics and pessimists. Their beliefs are self-fulfilling.

Arm yourself with specific knowledge, accountability, and leverage.

Specific knowledge is found by pursuing your genuine curiosity and passion rather than whatever is hot right now.

When specific knowledge is taught, it's through apprenticeships, not schools.

Embrace accountability, and take business risks under your own name. Society will reward you with responsibility, equity, and leverage.

"Give me a lever long enough, and a place to stand, and I will move the earth."
- Archimedes

Capital means money. To raise money, apply your specific knowledge, with accountability, and show resulting good judgment.

Capital and labor are permissioned leverage. Everyone is chasing capital, but someone has to give it to you. Everyone is trying to lead, but someone has to follow you.

An army of robots is freely available - it's just packed in data centers for heat and space efficiency. Use it.

Leverage is a force multiplier for your judgement

There is no skill called "business." Avoid business magazines and business classes.